

TELEPHONE POLICY - TEDS CAMERAS & DCW

Description

First impressions matter, and over the telephone, the words we choose and the way we deliver them shape the caller's perception of our businesses. Ted's Cameras and Digital Camera Warehouse (DCW) are committed to ensuring all phone calls are answered professionally, courteously, and consistently. This policy outlines the standard procedures all team members must follow to ensure customer enquiries are handled efficiently before the call ends.

Guidelines

1. Answer All Calls Promptly

- a. Industry research shows that callers become impatient after waiting more than six rings. Aim to answer all calls by the sixth ring whenever possible.
- b. Be aware of your surroundings. If the phone is ringing and you are the nearest available staff member, answer promptly and place the caller on hold politely if required.

2. Smile When Answering

- a. Whether the caller is a customer, supplier, complainant, or someone seeking information, it is your responsibility to greet them warmly. Smiling helps set a positive tone and ensures a welcoming attitude.

3. Balancing In-Store and Phone Customers

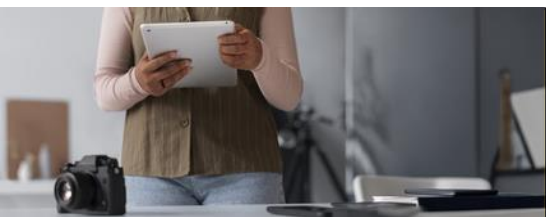
- a. If you are serving an in-store customer, excuse yourself politely to answer the phone.
- b. If the query is quick, handle it immediately. If it requires more time, explain to the caller that you are assisting a customer, place them on hold, and return to the in-store customer—thanking them for their patience.
- c. Do not leave a caller on hold for more than 60 seconds. If a longer delay is unavoidable, check whether they are happy to remain on hold or offer to call them back as soon as possible.
- d. When returning to the call, reintroduce yourself and thank the caller for waiting.

4. Standard Greeting

- a. Use the following greeting:
"Good morning/afternoon, Ted's Cameras/Digital Camera Warehouse (store name). This is (your name) speaking."
- b. Do not answer the phone with phrases such as "Please hold." Always answer with the full greeting before determining whether the caller needs to be placed on hold.

5. Listen Attentively

- a. Active listening shows the caller that they are valued and ensures a smoother, more efficient interaction.
- b. Avoid interrupting and allow the caller to fully explain their query before responding.



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6. Provide Verbal Rewards

- a. Use positive reinforcing phrases such as:
"Thank you for calling"
"I understand"
"Certainly"
"I can help with that"
- b. If the caller provides their name, use it naturally to personalise the conversation.

7. Transfer Calls Promptly

- a. If the caller requests a specific staff member or department, transfer the call promptly and efficiently.
- b. When transferring, communicate any relevant details the caller has already shared to avoid repetition.

8. Take Notes

- a. Keep a notepad and pen available at all times to ensure accurate recording of details.
- b. If the caller requests information on a product, note down all relevant details clearly.

9. Calls to/from Other Stores

- a. Inter-store calls—whether between Ted's Cameras or DCW—must be treated with the same professionalism, enthusiasm, and courtesy as customer calls.

10. Handling Complaints

- a. Follow all telephone service guidelines when dealing with complaints.
- b. Use verbal rewards to acknowledge frustration and apologise for any inconvenience.
- c. If an issue cannot be resolved immediately, take the caller's details and advise that you will follow up as soon as possible.
- d. Keep the caller informed if the resolution requires additional time.

11. Private Use

- a. Personal phone calls should only be made in emergencies and with Store Manager approval. Inform family and friends of this policy.
- b. Personal mobile phones must not be used while working. Mobile phones may be checked during breaks but should remain switched off or set to silent at all other times.
- c. Employees are responsible for securing their personal devices; Ted's Cameras and DCW are not liable for lost or stolen phones.

Support Office Guidelines

1. 24-Hour Call Return

- a. Support Office team members must return phone calls within 24 hours of receiving a message.
- b. If a full response cannot be provided within this time, contact the caller to acknowledge receipt and advise that further information will follow as soon as possible.

